

National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey

August 2021-August 2023 Data Documentation, Codebook, and Frequencies

Food Security (FSQ_L)

Data File: FSQ_L.xpt

First Published: December 2025

Last Revised: NA

Component Description

The Food Security section (variable name prefix FSQ) provides individual and household-level interview data on the following topics:

1. Household food security

In the household interview, an adult responded to the U.S. Food Security Survey Module (US FSSM) questions (Bickel G, et. al, 2000). All households were asked 10 questions. These questions refer to all household members, not just NHANES participants. One categorical household-level variable was created to characterize the food security status for adults in the household. The categorical variable derived from these responses is released on each household participant's record. Different from previous NHANES cycles, the 8 US FSSM items that were unique to households with children were not included in NHANES August 2021-August 2023 to reduce survey participant burden. Please refer to the Analytic Notes section for additional details.

A question on individual household members use of emergency foods from food banks, soup kitchens, or other organizations in the last 12 months is also included in this section.

2. Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP)/Food Stamp program benefits

All SNAP/Food Stamp benefits questions were collected at the household level. To obtain a more complete picture of all benefit recipients in the household, the data collection instruments were designed to identify each household member's SNAP/Food Stamp benefit receipt status using a household roster. The data were then summarized at the household level.

Within each household, for each family that participated in NHANES, one adult responded to questions about SNAP/Food Stamp benefits received by all household members. Information collected included whether anyone in the household had ever received SNAP/Food Stamp benefits; whether anyone in the household received benefits in the last 12 months; and whether anyone in the household is a current SNAP/Food Stamp benefits recipient. For households with benefit recipients in the past 12 months, the number of months benefits were received; the time since benefits were last received; and the amount of benefits the household received last was also collected.

Household-level data on SNAP/Food Stamp benefits are released on all household participants' records. The time since benefits were last received and the time until anticipated benefits will be received was calculated for each family within the household, based on the family interview date, and released at the family level.

3. Women, Infants and Children (WIC) program benefits

Data collected for WIC benefits included three household-level questions as well as six individual-level questions for participants aged birth to 5 years, and one individual-level question for participants 1-5 years.

In the household interview, an adult from each family responded to the question on whether anyone in the household received WIC benefits in the last 12 months, followed by questions on current WIC participation in the last 30 days and the number of people in the household receiving WIC benefits. These household-level questions are released on all household participants' records.

For participants aged birth to five years, information was collected on whether they ever received WIC benefits, current participation, total length (in months) of benefits received, and WIC participation during various important periods in early childhood, including prenatal, infancy, and 1-4 years old, and released on the individual participant's record.

The table in [Appendix 1](#) provides detailed information on each of the four FSQ components described above. [Appendix 2](#) highlights the changes in the FSQ section among the latest three release cycles.

Quality Assurance & Quality Control

The automated interview systems used in NHANES are programmed with built-in consistency checks to reduce data entry errors. All the data were reviewed for accuracy and completeness. NHANES staff reviewed audio recordings of interviews, traveled to field sites to observe interviews, read interviewer comments, and attended training and re-training sessions to maintain the high-quality data.

Data Processing and Editing

Frequency counts were checked, "skip" patterns were verified, and the reasonableness of question responses was reviewed. Edits were made to some variables to ensure the completeness, consistency, and analytic usefulness of the data. Edits were also made, when necessary, to address data disclosure concerns.

FSDAD (Adult food security category)

Ten FSSM questions were asked of households irrespective of if they had children. One categorical variable with four response levels was created based on the number of affirmative responses for those questions. This categorical variable could be used to characterize the overall food security status for the adults in the household. The algorithm used to derive the categorical variable is described below:

Count affirmative responses in these 10 items: FSD032a, FSD032b, FSD032c, FSD041, FSD052, FSD061, FSD071, FSD081, FSD092, and FSD102. Derive the codes as the following:

- 1 = Adult full food security: no affirmative response in any of these items.
- 2 = Adult marginal food security: 1-2 affirmative responses.
- 3 = Adult low food security: 3-5 affirmative responses.
- 4 = Adult very low food security: 6-10 affirmative responses.

No food security category is assigned if all or most of these items were answered as "don't know" or "refusal." There are 25 such records in the August 2021-August 2023 dataset. These records contain missing values for FSDAD.

FSD165-FSD235 (all variables for SNAP/Food Stamp benefits)

Information on the receipt of SNAP/Food Stamp benefits by all household members was provided in the present file: ever (FSQ165); the number of people ever received (FSD165N); received in the last 12 months (FSQ012); the number of people who received in the last 12 months (FSD012N); currently receiving (FSD230); the number of people currently receiving (FSD230N); number of months received benefits (FSD795); time since last received benefits (FSD225); and amount of benefits last received (FSD235). Receipt of SNAP/Food Stamp benefits by all individuals residing in the household, both survey and non-survey participants, was included. In households with more than one family where there were inconsistencies across families, all data were reviewed and reconciled.

FSD225 (Time since last received SNAP/Food Stamp benefits)

During the household interview, the respondent was asked to report the date that the household last received SNAP/Food Stamp benefits. A variable was then derived by calculating the number of days between the time the household last received the SNAP/Food Stamp benefit and the date of interview for the corresponding family. The derived variable was released as FSD225 at the family level.

FSQ235 (Amount last received SNAP/Food Stamp benefits)

The amount last received in benefits was determined by asking about the date and the amount last received by all persons in the household who received SNAP/Food Stamps in the last 12 months. The latest amount received by the household was released at the household level.

FSD795 (number of months received SNAP/Food Stamp benefits)

The number of months SNAP/Food Stamp benefits were received is included for households with current recipients and those who received them in the last 12 months. When a household had both current recipients and past recipients in the last 12 months, the total number of months were calculated by checking for overlapping months. For example, if a household member is currently receiving benefits from May to July, and another household member received benefits from February to May, the total number of months was 6 ($2 + 4 = 6$), in the past 12 months.

FSD760N (number of people in the household received WIC benefits in the past 30 days)

The family respondent was asked whether anyone living in the household received WIC benefits in the past 30 days. Respondents with affirmative answers were followed up with a question (i.e., FSQ770) asking them to identify all persons living in the household who received benefits from a household roster. In addition to these household-level questions, child participants were also asked about whether they were receiving WIC benefits at the time of their own interviews (i.e., FSD660ZC). Responses to FSQ770 and FSD660ZC were used to derive the data in FSD760N. Receipt of WIC benefits by both survey and non-survey participants residing in the household was included. In households with more than one family where there were inconsistencies across families, all data were reviewed and reconciled.

FSD670ZC (number of months the participant received WIC benefits)

This information was collected using two-part (number and unit) questions to allow respondents to report the length in either months or years. The released variable was edited to standardize the reported length to number of months.

Analytic Notes

NHANES has assessed household food security with the U.S. Food Security Survey Module (US FSSM) since 1999. In the August 2021-August 2023 cycle, the 8 items of the US FSSM that were unique to households with children were dropped to reduce survey participant burden. As result, the derived variable encoding household food security categories utilizing the full 18 US FSSM items (i.e., FSDHH) is not included in the present dataset. The adult food security category indicator (FSDAD) is still reported for all participants in the present dataset. FSDAD was derived from the 10 basic US FSSM items, including questions on overall household experiences associated with difficulty in meeting food needs, and specific questions on related behaviors among adult household members. Users should be cautious when comparing data from NHANES August 2021-August 2023 with previous survey cycles, and with reports using separate food security category indicators for households with and without children, such as the [Household Food Security in the United States in 2023](#) (Rabbitt MP, et. al, 2024). For more information on food security measurement, please refer to the USDA's website at: [Food Security in the U.S. - Measurement / Economic Research Service](#).

In the August 2021-August 2023 cycle, detailed individual-level WIC participation questions for women aged 12 years and over were dropped to reduce survey participant burden. However, their participation in the last 12 months and last 30 days would be included in the household level WIC participation items (i.e., FSD162, FSQ760, and FSD760N).

The NHANES household interview included two questionnaires: a sample participant questionnaire to collect information regarding each individual survey participant's personal health status, and a family questionnaire to collect information at the family level, such as total income for the family, food availability in the family, etc. The sample participant questionnaire was answered by participants themselves (adult proxy for child under 16 years old). The family questionnaire required an adult family member, preferably the head of the family, to respond to these questions for the entire family. The information on household food security status and SNAP/Food Stamp program as well as WIC program benefits in the FSQ section were collected as part of this family questionnaire. In August 2021-August 2023, 1,325 participants had missing values for all of these items in the FSQ section because the family questionnaire was not administered. Most common reasons for missing the family questionnaire interview were: "no eligible adult respondent in the family available" or "refusal."

FSQ data were collected as part of the household interview. Thus, the interview sample weights should be used in their analysis. However, if the data analysis requires merging of these data with data collected in the MEC, examination sample weights should be used for analyses. Please refer to the [NHANES Analytic Guidelines](#) and the on-line [NHANES Tutorial](#) for further details on the use of sample weights and other analytic issues. Both are available on the NHANES website.

References

- Bickel G, Nord M, Price C, Hamilton W, Cook J. Guide to Measuring Household Food Security Revised 2000. U.S. Department of Agriculture, Food and Nutrition Service, Alexandria VA. March, 2000. Available from: <https://fns-prod.azureedge.us/sites/default/files/FSGuide.pdf> [Accessed on: 12/12/2025]
- Rabbitt MP, Reed-Jones M, Hales LJ, & Burke MP. (2024). Household food security in the United States in 2023 (Report No. ERR-337). U.S. Department of Agriculture, Economic Research Service. Available from: https://ers.usda.gov/sites/default/files/_laserfiche/publications/109896/ERR-337.pdf?v=63714 [Accessed on: 12/12/2025]

Codebook and Frequencies

SEQN - Respondent sequence number

Variable Name:	SEQN
SAS Label:	Respondent sequence number
English Text:	Respondent sequence number.
Target:	Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

FSD032A - HH Worried run out of food

Variable Name: FSD032A

SAS Label: HH Worried run out of food

English Text: Now I am going to read you several statements that people have made about their food situation. For these statements, please tell me whether the statement was often true, sometimes true, or never true for {you/your household} in the last 12 months, that is since last {DISPLAY CURRENT MONTH AND LAST YEAR}. The first statement is . . . {I/we} worried whether {my/our} food would run out before {I/we} got money to buy more.

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Often true	993	993	
2	Sometimes true	2143	3136	
3	Never true	7440	10576	
7	Refused	27	10603	
9	Don't know	3	10606	
.	Missing	1327	11933	

FSD032B - HH Food didn't last

Variable Name: FSD032B**SAS Label:** HH Food didn't last**English Text:** [The next statement is . . .] The food that {I/we} bought just didn't last, and {I/we} didn't have enough money to get more food.**English Instructions:** Collected at household level.**Target:** Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Often true	742	742	
2	Sometimes true	1858	2600	
3	Never true	7971	10571	
7	Refused	28	10599	
9	Don't know	7	10606	
.	Missing	1327	11933	

FSD032C - HH Couldn't afford balanced meals

Variable Name: FSD032C

SAS Label: HH Couldn't afford balanced meals

English Text: [The next statement is . . .] {I/we} couldn't afford to eat balanced meals.

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Often true	697	697	
2	Sometimes true	1652	2349	
3	Never true	8226	10575	
7	Refused	26	10601	
9	Don't know	5	10606	
.	Missing	1327	11933	

FSQBOX1 - CHECK ITEM

Variable Name:	FSQBOX1
English Instructions:	BOX 1. CHECK ITEM: IF RESPONSE TO FSD032 'A', 'B', or 'C' IS CODE 1 OR 2 (OFTEN TRUE OR SOMETIMES TRUE), CONTINUE. OTHERWISE, GO TO FSDAD.
Target:	Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

FSD041 - HH Adults cut size or skip meals

Variable Name: FSD041

SAS Label: HH Adults cut size or skip meals

English Text: In the last 12 months, since last {DISPLAY CURRENT MONTH AND LAST YEAR}, did {you/you or other adults in your household} ever cut the size of your meals or skip meals because there wasn't enough money for food?

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	1527	1527	
2	No	2110	3637	FSD061
7	Refused	0	3637	FSD061
9	Don't know	5	3642	FSD061
.	Missing	8291	11933	

FSD052 - HH How often adults cut size/skip meals

Variable Name: FSD052

SAS Label: HH How often adults cut size/skip meals

English Text: How often did this happen?

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Almost every month,	428	428	
2	Some months but not every month, or	704	1132	
3	Only 1 or 2 months?	395	1527	
7	Refused	0	1527	
9	Don't know	0	1527	
.	Missing	10406	11933	

FSD061 - HH Eat less than should

Variable Name: FSD061

SAS Label: HH Eat less than should

English Text: In the last 12 months, did you ever eat less than you felt you should because there wasn't enough money for food?

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	1455	1455	
2	No	2184	3639	
7	Refused	0	3639	
9	Don't know	3	3642	
.	Missing	8291	11933	

FSD071 - HH Hungry, but didn't eat

Variable Name: FSD071

SAS Label: HH Hungry, but didn't eat

English Text: [In the last 12 months], were you ever hungry but didn't eat because there wasn't enough money for food?

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	835	835	
2	No	2806	3641	
7	Refused	0	3641	
9	Don't know	1	3642	
.	Missing	8291	11933	

FSD081 - HH Lost weight, no money for food

Variable Name: FSD081

SAS Label: HH Lost weight, no money for food

English Text: [In the last 12 months], did you lose weight because there wasn't enough money for food?

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	558	558	
2	No	3064	3622	
7	Refused	0	3622	
9	Don't know	20	3642	
.	Missing	8291	11933	

FSQBOX2 - CHECK ITEM

Variable Name: FSQBOX2

English Instructions: BOX 2. CHECK ITEM: IF RESPONSE TO FSD041, FSD061, FSD071, OR FSD081 IS CODE 1 (YES), CONTINUE. OTHERWISE GO TO FSDAD.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

FSD092 - HH Adults not eat whole day

Variable Name: FSD092

SAS Label: HH Adults not eat whole day

English Text: [In the last 12 months], did {you/you or other adults in your household} ever not eat for a whole day because there wasn't enough money for food?

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	356	356	
2	No	1455	1811	
7	Refused	1	1812	
9	Don't know	1	1813	
.	Missing	10120	11933	

FSD102 - HH How often adults not eat for day

Variable Name: FSD102

SAS Label: HH How often adults not eat for day

English Text: How often did this happen?

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Almost every month,	107	107	
2	Some months but not every month, or	161	268	
3	Only 1 or 2 months?	88	356	
7	Refused	0	356	
9	Don't know	0	356	
.	Missing	11577	11933	

FSDAD - Adult food security category

Variable Name: FSDAD

SAS Label: Adult food security category

English Text: Adult food security category for last 12 months

English Instructions: Calculated at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	AD full food security: 0	6939	6939	
2	AD marginal food security: 1-2	1376	8315	
3	AD low food security: 3-5	1234	9549	
4	AD very low food security: 6-10	1032	10581	
.	Missing	1352	11933	

FSD151 - HH Emergency food received

Variable Name: FSD151

SAS Label: HH Emergency food received

English Text: In the last 12 months, did {you/you or any member of your household} ever get emergency food from a church, a food pantry, or a food bank, or eat in a soup kitchen?

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	1730	1730	
2	No	8853	10583	
7	Refused	22	10605	
9	Don't know	7	10612	
.	Missing	1321	11933	

FSQ165 - HH FS benefit: ever received

Variable Name: FSQ165

SAS Label: HH FS benefit: ever received

English Text: The next questions are about SNAP, the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, formerly known as the Food Stamp Program. SNAP benefits are provided on an electronic debit card {or EBT card} {called the {DISPLAY STATE NAME FOR EBT CARD}} card in STATE}. Have {you/you or anyone in your household} ever received SNAP or Food Stamp benefits?

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	4830	4830	
2	No	5695	10525	FSQBOX5
7	Refused	31	10556	FSQBOX5
9	Don't know	31	10587	FSQBOX5
.	Missing	1346	11933	

FSD165N - HH FS benefit: # of people ever received

Variable Name: FSD165N

SAS Label: HH FS benefit: # of people ever received

English Text: How many people in your household ever received SNAP or Food Stamp benefits?

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1 to 6	Range of Values	4674	4674	
7	7 or more	150	4824	
77	Refused	1	4825	
99	Don't know	5	4830	
.	Missing	7103	11933	

FSQ012 - HH FS benefit: receive in last 12 months

Variable Name: FSQ012**SAS Label:** HH FS benefit: receive in last 12 months**English Text:** In the last 12 months, did {you/you or any member of your household} receive SNAP or Food Stamp benefits?**English Instructions:** Collected at household level.**Target:** Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	3005	3005	
2	No	1817	4822	FSQBOX5
7	Refused	1	4823	FSQBOX5
9	Don't know	7	4830	FSQBOX5
.	Missing	7103	11933	

FSD012N - HH FS benefit: # of people received(12m)**Variable Name:** FSD012N**SAS Label:** HH FS benefit: # of people received(12m)**English Text:** In the last 12 months, how many people in your household received SNAP or Food Stamp benefits?**English Instructions:** Collected on household level.**Target:** Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1 to 6	Range of Values	2895	2895	
7	7 or more	110	3005	
77	Refused	0	3005	
99	Don't know	0	3005	
.	Missing	8928	11933	

FSD230 - HH FS benefit: currently receive

Variable Name: FSD230

SAS Label: HH FS benefit: currently receive

English Text: {Do you/Does any member of your household} currently receive SNAP or Food Stamp benefits?

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	2400	2400	
2	No	602	3002	FSD795
7	Refused	0	3002	FSD795
9	Don't know	3	3005	FSD795
.	Missing	8928	11933	

FSD230N - HH FS benefit: #people currently receive**Variable Name:** FSD230N**SAS Label:** HH FS benefit: #people currently receive**English Text:** How many people in your household currently receive SNAP or Food Stamp benefits?**English Instructions:** Collected at household level.**Target:** Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1 to 6	Range of Values	2290	2290	
7	7 or more	110	2400	
77	Refused	0	2400	
99	Don't know	0	2400	
.	Missing	9533	11933	

FSD795 - HH FS benefit: # of months received**Variable Name:** FSD795**SAS Label:** HH FS benefit: # of months received**English Text:** During the past 12 months, for how many months did {you/{NAME(S)}} get Food Stamps?**English Instructions:** Calculated at household level.**Target:** Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1 to 12	Range of Values	2923	2923	
77	Refused	12	2935	
99	Don't know	70	3005	
.	Missing	8928	11933	

FSD225 - HH FS benefit: time since last received

Variable Name: FSD225

SAS Label: HH FS benefit: time since last received

English Text: Number of days between the time the household last received Food Stamp benefit and the date of interview.

English Instructions: Calculated at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
0 to 296	Range of Values	2444	2444	
55555	More than 300 days	21	2465	
77777	Refused	23	2488	
99999	Don't know	512	3000	
.	Missing	8933	11933	

FSD235 - HH FS benefit: amount received last time

Variable Name: FSD235

SAS Label: HH FS benefit: amount received last time

English Text: How much did {you/your household} receive in food stamp benefits the last time you got them? ENTER DOLLAR AMOUNT.

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
8 to 1000	Range of Values	2482	2482	
55555	More than \$1,000	195	2677	
77777	Refused	61	2738	
99999	Don't know	267	3005	
.	Missing	8928	11933	

FSQBOX5 - CHECK ITEM

Variable Name:	FSQBOX5
English Instructions:	BOX 5. CHECK ITEM: IF THERE IS AT LEAST 1 CHILD IN THE HOUSEHOLD WHO IS 0-5 YEARS OLD OR THERE IS A FEMALE IN THE HOUSEHOLD WHO IS BETWEEN 20 AND 59 YEARS OLD, CONTINUE. OTHERWISE, GO TO BOX 6.
Target:	Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

FSD162 - HH WIC benefit: receive in last 12 month

Variable Name: FSD162

SAS Label: HH WIC benefit: receive in last 12 month

English Text: Next are a few questions about the WIC program, that is, the Women, Infants and Children program. In the last 12 months, did {you/you or any member of your household} receive benefits from the WIC program?

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	1044	1044	
2	No	9530	10574	FSQBOX6
7	Refused	15	10589	FSQBOX6
9	Don't know	32	10621	FSQBOX6
.	Missing	1312	11933	

FSQ760 - HH WIC benefit: received in last 30 days

Variable Name: FSQ760

SAS Label: HH WIC benefit: received in last 30 days

English Text: Did {you/you or anyone who lives here} receive WIC benefits in the past 30 days? {Here is the list of children 5 years and younger and women ages 12 to 59 years who live here, let me read it to you.}

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	785	785	
2	No	259	1044	FSQBOX6
7	Refused	0	1044	FSQBOX6
9	Don't know	0	1044	FSQBOX6
.	Missing	10889	11933	

FSD760N - HH WIC benefit: no. people received

Variable Name: FSD760N

SAS Label: HH WIC benefit: no. people received

English Text: How many people in your household received WIC in the past 30 days?

English Instructions: Collected at household level.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1 to 6	Range of Values	781	781	
77	Refused	3	784	
99	Don't know	1	785	
.	Missing	11148	11933	

FSQBOX6 - CHECK ITEM

Variable Name:	FSQBOX6
English Instructions:	BOX 6. CHECK ITEM: IF THE RESPONDENT AGE BETWEEN 0-5 YEARS, CONTINUE WITH FSQ653. OTHERWISE, GO TO END OF SECTION.
Target:	Both males and females 0 YEARS - 150 YEARS

FSQ653 - CH WIC benefit: ever received

Variable Name: FSQ653

SAS Label: CH WIC benefit: ever received

English Text: Next are a few questions about the WIC program. Has {SP} ever received benefits from WIC, that is, the Women, Infants, and Children program?

English Instructions: Collected at individual level in the household interview.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 5 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	645	645	
2	No	585	1230	FSQ690
7	Refused	0	1230	FSQ690
9	Don't know	7	1237	FSQ690
.	Missing	10696	11933	

FSD660ZC - CH WIC benefit: currently receive

Variable Name: FSD660ZC

SAS Label: CH WIC benefit: currently receive

English Text: Is {SP} now receiving benefits from the WIC program?

English Instructions: Collected at individual level in the household interview.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 5 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	318	318	
2	No	324	642	
7	Refused	0	642	
9	Don't know	3	645	
.	Missing	11288	11933	

FSD675 - CH WIC benefit: received in infancy

Variable Name: FSD675

SAS Label: CH WIC benefit: received in infancy

English Text: Did {SP} receive benefits from WIC when {he/she} was less than one year old?

English Instructions: Collected at individual level in the household interview.

Target: Both males and females 0 YEARS - 5 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	600	600	
2	No	39	639	
7	Refused	0	639	
9	Don't know	6	645	
.	Missing	11288	11933	

FSD680 - CH WIC benefit: received b/w 1-4 yrs old

Variable Name: FSD680

SAS Label: CH WIC benefit: received b/w 1-4 yrs old

English Text: Did {SP} receive benefits from WIC when {he/she} {was/is} between the ages of {1 to {SP AGE/4} years old/12 to {SP AGE} months old}?

English Instructions: Collected at individual level in the household interview.

Target: Both males and females 1 YEARS - 5 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	387	387	
2	No	120	507	
7	Refused	0	507	
9	Don't know	1	508	
.	Missing	11425	11933	

FSD670ZC - CH WIC benefit: # of months received**Variable Name:** FSD670ZC**SAS Label:** CH WIC benefit: # of months received**English Text:** How long {did SP receive/has SP been receiving} benefits from the WIC program?**English Instructions:** Collected at individual level in the household interview.**Target:** Both males and females 0 YEARS - 5 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
0 to 60	Range of Values	638	638	
777	Refused	0	638	
999	Don't know	7	645	
.	Missing	11288	11933	

FSQ690 - CH WIC benefit: Mom received while preg.**Variable Name:** FSQ690**SAS Label:** CH WIC benefit: Mom received while preg.**English Text:** Did {SP's} mother receive benefits from WIC, while she was pregnant with {SP}?**English Instructions:** Collected at individual level in the household interview.**Target:** Both males and females 0 YEARS - 5 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1	Yes	505	505	
2	No	709	1214	End of Section
7	Refused	0	1214	End of Section
9	Don't know	23	1237	End of Section
.	Missing	10696	11933	

FSQ695 - CH WIC benefit: starting month of preg.**Variable Name:** FSQ695**SAS Label:** CH WIC benefit: starting month of preg.**English Text:** What month of the pregnancy did {SP's} mother begin to receive WIC benefits?**English Instructions:** Collected at individual level in the household interview.**Target:** Both males and females 0 YEARS - 5 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1 to 9	Range of Values	480	480	
77	Refused	0	480	
99	Don't know	25	505	
.	Missing	11428	11933	

Appendix 1

Components of the Food Security (FSQ) section in August 2021-August 2023

Component	Data Collection Details	Variable Name	Target: Gender Age	Label
Household Food Security	Food Security (FSQ) Family Interview Household Level	FSD032A	MF (0-150)	HH Worried run out of food
		FSD032B	MF (0-150)	HH Food didn't last
		FSD032C	MF (0-150)	HH Couldn't afford balanced meals
		FSD041	MF (0-150)	HH Adults cut size or skip meals
		FSD052	MF (0-150)	HH How often adults cut size/skip meals
		FSD061	MF (0-150)	HH Eat less than should
		FSD071	MF (0-150)	HH Hungry, but didn't eat
		FSD081	MF (0-150)	HH Lost weight, no money for food
		FSD092	MF (0-150)	HH Adults not eat whole day
		FSD102	MF (0-150)	HH How often adults not eat for day
		FSDAD	MF (0-150)	Adult food security category
		FSD151	MF (0-150)	HH Emergency food received
Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP)/Food Stamp Program Benefits	Food Security (FSQ) Family Interview Household Level	FSQ165	MF (0-150)	HH FS benefit: ever received
		FSQ165N	MF (0-150)	HH FS benefit: no. people ever received
		FSQ012	MF (0-150)	HH FS benefit: receive in last 12 months
		FSD012N	MF (0-150)	HH FS benefit: No. people received (12 m)
		FSD230	MF (0-150)	HH FS benefit: currently receive
		FSD230N	MF (0-150)	HH FS benefit: no. people currently receive
		FSD795	MF (0-150)	HH FS benefit: no. months received
		FSD225	MF (0-150)	HH FS benefit: time since last received
		FSQ235	MF (0-150)	HH FS benefit: amount received

Component	Data Collection Details	Variable Name	Target: Gender Age	Label
				last time
		FSD855	MF (0-150)	HH FS benefit: anticipate will receive
		FSD860	MF (0-150)	HH FS benefit: time will receive
		FSQ865	MF (0-150)	HH FS benefit: amount will receive
Women, Infants and Children (WIC) Program Benefits	Food Security (FSQ) Family Interview Household level	FSQ162	MF (0-150)	HH WIC benefit: receive in last 12 month
		FSQ760	MF (0-150)	HH WIC benefit: receive in last 30 days
		FSQ760N	MF (0-150)	HH WIC benefit: # of people received
	Diet Behavior (DBQ) Household Interview Individual level	FSQ653	MF (0-5)	CH WIC benefit: Ever received
		FSD660ZC	MF (0-5)	CH WIC benefit: currently receive
		FSD675	MF (0-5)	CH WIC benefit: received in infancy
		FSD680	MF (1-5)	CH WIC benefit: received b/w 1-4 yrs old
		FSD670ZC	MF (0-5)	CH WIC benefit: # of months received
		FSQ690	MF (0-5)	CH WIC benefit: mom received while preg.
		FSQ695	MF (0-5)	CH WIC benefit: starting month of preg.

Appendix 2

Changes in the FSQ section among the last 3 release cycles

Item	2015-2016	2017-2018	2021-2023
U.S. Food Security Survey Module (US FSSM) questions	10 items collected for all households; 8 additional items collected for households with children under the age of 18 years.	No change from 2015-2016	10 items continuously collected for all households; 8 additional items previously collected for households with children under the age of 18 years were dropped.
Household food security category	Derived for all households by counting affirmative responses in the 18 US FSSM items	No change from 2015-2016	No longer available
Child food security category	Derived for all households with children under the age of 18 by counting affirmative responses in the 8 US FSSM items that are specific to household with children.	No change from 2015-2016	No longer available
Household members notified to receive Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP)/Food Stamp (FS) benefits in the next 30 days	Collected and released at household level. Response was confirmed by a follow-up question using a household roster for the respondent to identify household members who were notified to receive benefits in the next 30 days	No change from 2015-2016	No longer collected
Women received WIC benefits during latest pregnancy	Collected for women who were pregnant or 0-24 months postpartum at the time of interview	No change from 2015-2016	No longer collected
The month of the latest pregnancy when the women participant started to receive WIC benefits	Collected for women who were pregnant or 0-24 months postpartum at the time of interview	No change from 2015-2016	No longer collected
Women received WIC benefits post-partum, last pregnancy	Collected for women who were 0-24 months postpartum at the time of interview	No change from 2015-2016	No longer collected
Women currently receive WIC benefits	Collected for women who were pregnant or 0-24 months postpartum at the time of interview	No change from 2015-2016	No longer collected